

Zhennan Yi

PHD STUDENT, HUMAN-ROBOT INTERACTION RESEARCHER

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Education

Indiana University Bloomington

PhD Student in Informatics (Intelligent & Interactive System Track) advised by Dr. Selma Šabanović

Bloomington, IN, USA

2024 – 2029 (expected)

Beijing Normal University

Bachelor of Science in Psychology

Beijing, China

2024

University of Glasgow

Visiting Student at the School of Computing Science

Glasgow, Scotland, UK

2023

University of Manchester

Exchange Program

Manchester, England, UK

2022–2023

Publications

For a full list of publications, please see my [Google Scholar profile](#).

2026

DIS Zhennan Yi, Lingyun Chen, Paulina Maria Zguda, Randy Gomez, and Selma Šabanović. 2026. Rethinking Pedagogical Relationships in the Presence of Social Robots. In Proceedings of the 2026 ACM Designing Interactive Systems Conference (DIS '26).

CSCW Yuling Sun, Zhennan Yi, Junyan Mao, Minglong Tang, Xiaojuan Ma, Ruiqi Chen, Zhifan Guo, Xin Tong, and Ning Gu. 2026. Situated Use and Negotiated Effectiveness: Critical Considerations of GenAI-Powered Reminiscence Intervention for People with Dementia. In Proceedings of the ACM on Human-Computer Interaction (CSCW '26).

HRI Zhennan Yi, Sophia Sakakibara Capello, Randy Gomez, and Selma Šabanović. 2026. Adding More Value Than Work: Practical Guidelines for Integrating Robots into Intercultural Competence Learning. In Proceedings of the 21st ACM/IEEE International Conference on Human-Robot Interaction (HRI '26).

2025

DIS Zhennan Yi, Xianghua(Sharon) Ding, Chenyang You, and Xingchen Zhou. 2025. Smiles, Frowns, and Everything In Between: Understanding User Experiences with Emotion Tracking in Daily Life through Facial Expression Recognition. In Proceedings of the 2025 ACM Designing Interactive Systems Conference (DIS '25).

RO-MAN Zhennan Yi, Leigh Levinson, Diego Delgado-Chaves, Jose Manuel Perez-Moleron, Nabil Bougria, Antonia Krummheuer, Matthias Rehm, Anders Kalsgaard Møller, Katrine Kielsholm Ramsgaard, Selma Auala, Heike Winschiers-Theophilus, Edward Nepolo, David Calero, Devis Dal Moro, Daniel Serrano, Magí Dalmau-Moreno, Randy Gomez, Luis Merino, Selma Šabanović. 2025. Building Friendships Across Borders: The Role of Social Robot Haru in Children Group Communication and Connection Development. In 2025 34th IEEE International Conference on Robot and Human Interactive Communication (ROMAN '25).

2024

CHI Yuling Sun, Zhennan Yi, Xiaojuan Ma, Junyan Mao, and Xin Tong. 2024. Technology-Mediated Non-pharmacological Interventions for Dementia: Needs for and Challenges in Professional, Personalized and Multi-Stakeholder Collaborative Interventions. In Proceedings of the 2024 CHI Conference on Human Factors in Computing Systems (CHI '24).

CHI EA Jiasi Gao, An Chen, Zhennan Yi, Xueye Yan, Jiayi Liu, Guyue Zhou, and Jiangtao Gong. 2024. Not a Playroom, but a Passage: Exploring the Design Space of a Technology-mediated Calm-down Corner. In Extended Abstracts of the CHI Conference on Human Factors in Computing Systems (CHI EA '24).

Honors, Awards and Recognitions

CRA-WP Graduate Cohort , <i>Computing Research Association</i>	2026
Special Recognitions for Outstanding Reviews , <i>HRI 2026, C&C 2026</i>	2026
Top Cited Article in <i>Developmental Science</i> , <i>WILEY</i>	2025
Top Cited Article in <i>Child Development</i> , <i>WILEY</i>	2025
Summer Fellowship (\$10,000), <i>Indiana University Bloomington</i>	2024
Best Paper Award , <i>CHI Conference 2024</i>	2024
Best Design Award , <i>The 6th Global Competition on Design for Future Education</i>	2023
Social Work Award , <i>Beijing Normal University</i>	2022
First-Class Academic Scholarship , <i>Beijing Normal University</i>	2021 & 2022

Invited Talks and Presentations

“Designing for Teacher-Robot Partnerships”, at <i>University of British Columbia, Canada</i>	2026-03-24
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Services and Involvement

Associate Chair (AC)	DIS 2026 PWiP Track
Reviewer	CHI 2026, HRI 2026, DIS 2026, C&C 2026
Volunteer	DIS 2025
Instructor	Designed and led a robotics workshop for girls (grades 6–12), guiding them in designing, building, and programming robots to foster STEM interest through hands-on learning in the 2025 Robotics Program organized by Girl Scouts and WonderLab.